

Duong Phuc Ta

Applied Economist & Data Analyst | Ph.D. Candidate, Agricultural and Applied Economics, Virginia Tech
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 [LinkedIn](#) |  [Github](#) |  [Google Scholar](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Applied economist with 15+ years of experience (2010–present) researching agriculture, climate, and trade in Vietnam and the U.S. Skilled in causal inference (difference-in-differences, instrumental variables, double/debiased machine learning) and large-scale survey data analysis using Python, Stata, and R. Author or co-author of 8 journal publications, with current research on climate stress and milk production and a silvopasture manuscript under review.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming & Statistical Software:** Stata, Python, R, SQL, LaTeX
- **Econometric & Causal Inference Methods:** Difference-in-Differences, Panel Data Models, Double/Debiased Machine Learning, Cost-Benefit Analysis
- **Machine Learning & Data Science:** Scikit-learn, Pytorch, TensorFlow
- **Web Data Collection:** Python-based scraping and AI-assisted crawling tools
- **Geospatial & Remote Sensing:** Google Earth Engine, QGIS
- **Reproducibility & Collaboration Tools:** Git, GitHub, Quarto

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Virginia Tech**  2023 – present
USA
Graduate Research & Teaching Assistant
 - Develop the current job market paper, “Estimating impacts of climate stress on US milk production: a panel data with debiased machine learning approach”, as first author.
 - First author of “Economic Feasibility and Carbon Sequestration of Silvopasture in the Southeastern U.S.” Submitted to a journal and under review. Presented at the 2025 AAEA-WAEA Annual Meeting.
 - Support instruction for undergraduate and graduate courses in the Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, including lab sections and grading.
- **The International Center for Tropical Agriculture (CIAT), Asia Hub**  2018 – 2022
Vietnam
Research Assistant / Data Analyst (held concurrently with the VIE research post)
 - Developed questionnaires and CSPro survey programs and supervised data collection for projects on salinity intrusion and rice production in the Mekong Delta (2019–2022) and cassava production and value chains in Vietnam (2019–2021).
 - Managed and cleaned the resulting survey data and built econometric analysis pipelines in R and Stata, contributing to two peer-reviewed publications (*Climate and Development*, 2022; *Journal of the Agricultural and Applied Economics Association*, 2025).
- **Vietnam Institute of Economics (VIE)**  2010 – 2023
Vietnam
Researcher
 - Led projects on farm and non-farm employment in Vietnam’s rural economy (2022) and agricultural structure under climate change in the Mekong Delta (2021), including proposals, data analysis, and final research reports.
 - Studied trade and structural adjustment, non-farm livelihoods, agricultural income diversification, and climate adaptation among Vietnamese households.
 - Authored or co-authored 7 journal publications (2015–2023) on rural livelihoods, climate adaptation, and structural transformation.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Mills et al. (2025), incl. Ta. “Salinity Inundation, Profitability, and Rice Farming Exits in Mekong Delta of Vietnam”. *J. of the Agricultural and Applied Economics Assoc.*, 4(2), 170-186.
 - [2] Mills et al. (2022), incl. Ta. “Intensive and Extensive Rice Farm Adaptations in Salinity-Prone Areas of the Mekong Delta”. *Climate and Development*, 15(2), 162-176.
 - [3] Nguyen Dinh Chuc and Ta Phuc Duong (2019). “Trade, Structural Adjustments and Productivity Growth in Vietnam: The Shift to Services”. *J. of Southeast Asian Economies*, 36(2), 256-273.
 - [4] Ta Phuc Duong (2015). “Effects of Capital Flows on Housing Prices in Emerging Economies: A Panel Approach”. *Vietnam’s Socio-Economic Development*, No. 81 (April 2015).
- Plus 4 Vietnamese-language publications and 2 current papers, including the job market paper, listed in the academic CV.

EDUCATION

- **Virginia Tech** 2023 – Expected 2028
USA
Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics
- **University of Greenwich** 2014 - 2015
United Kingdom
MSc in Business and Financial Economics
- **The National Economics University** 2004 - 2008
Vietnam
Bachelor in Economics

CERTIFICATIONS & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Certifications: Machine Learning Specialization, Stanford University via Coursera (3 courses), 2025

Affiliations: Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA)

Languages: Vietnamese (native), English (fluent)